

WATERWALKER · REQUIREMENTS

WaterWalker requirements

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DOCUMENT CONTROL

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Project TRL	TRL 3 Proof of concept		
Repository	github.com/BoujeeEnjinia1701/waterwalker		
Source	docs/03-requirements.md @ 821b363		

REVISION HISTORY

Version	Date	Author	Change
0.4	2026-09-25	Amish Chadha	Recommendations accepted by Amish (DDR-002); R10 restated for the positive lock pin; status updated from WWK-CAL-001 v0.2
0.3	2026-09-25	Amish Chadha	TRL 3. Record Amish's decisions (WWK-DDR-001); redefine R1 (four jerrycans or two clay pots) and R11 (budget covers the unassisted first prototype with mounting points); add R13 (assist-ready to SwapCell interface v0.3); add status from WWK-CAL-001
0.2	2026-09-24	Amish Chadha	First measurable requirements for TRL 2
0.1	2026-09-24	Amish Chadha	Initial scaffold

WaterWalker requirements

Two of the thirteen requirements are not met on paper (R3 and R9), seven are at risk and three are met, according to the TRL 3 calculations in WWK-CAL-001 v0.2. Targets are still desk proposals and must be revised from co-design sessions with the intended users (WWK-PRB-001) before the design is frozen. On 2026-09-25 Amish decided to build the first prototype without assist but with mounting points, keep the \$450 budget, and carry four jerrycans or two clay pots (WWK-DDR-001); R1 and R11 are redefined to match, and R13 is new. Later the same day Amish accepted the remaining recommendations (WWK-DDR-002): a 1.2 mm main-tube wall and a thinner cradle, which bring R2 and R4 from not met to at risk and R11 to met, and a positive parking lock pin, for which R10 is restated. R9 stays not met and is to be revisited with users in co-design.

Table 1. Requirements and status at TRL 3 (WWK-CAL-001).

ID	Requirement	Target	Verification (TRL 3 or later)	Status at TRL 3
R1	Carry a household's water in one trip	80 L of water in four 20 L jerrycans, or 40 L in two 20 L clay pots; rated gross payload 90 kg including containers (redefined 2026-09-25, WWK-DDR-001)	Cradle layout in the parametric model; later load test	At risk: two 380 mm pots fit with 12 mm to spare
R2	Easy to push on firm ground	Sustained push force 60 N or less at rated load on a firm, level dirt path	Rolling resistance calculation; later force gauge on a field path	At risk: 23.9 to 59.7 N
R3	Usable on loose sand	Sustained push force 150 N or less at rated load on loose sand, with assist if fitted	Calculation from sinkage and rolling resistance; later field test	Not met: 236 to 358 N (no assist on the first prototype)
R4	Climb and descend slopes	Climb a 10 % grade on firm ground with a push force of 180 N or less for up to 100 m; descend a 10 % grade under control with the service brake	Force calculation; brake sizing	At risk: 178.3 N at the rough end; descent met on paper
R5	Turn without lifting	180 degree turn within a 4.0 m diameter circle without lifting or skidding a wheel; reverse by pulling back	Geometry of the parametric model	Met: 3.66 m
R6	Fit narrow paths and gates	Overall width 900 mm or less	Parametric model	At risk: 898 mm
R7	Walk-in fit for all users	No step-over at the rear entry (50 mm or less); clear walking width 600 mm or more; hip bar height adjustable 850 to 1,050 mm; skirt guards on both rear wheels	Parametric model; later co-design fitting sessions	At risk: walking width 610 mm
R8	Easy loading	Containers lifted no higher than 450 mm above the ground; loadable from either side without removing parts	Parametric model	Met: 364 mm
R9	Light enough to handle empty	Empty mass 35 kg or less without assist, 42 kg or less with assist	Mass roll-up from the parametric model	Not met: 37.4 kg (43.9 kg); to be revisited with users in co-design (WWK-DDR-002)
R10	Safe braking and parking	Service brake on both rear wheels operable while walking; a positive parking lock (lock pin through a rear wheel) that needs no sustained hand force holds the rated gross mass on a 20 % grade; the lever latch serves short stops (restated 2026-09-25, WWK-DDR-002)	Brake force calculation; later parking test	At risk: lock pin fitted; tire friction 0.41 needed; latch 184 N
R11	Affordable first prototype	Parts for the first prototype, without assist and with assist mounting points, \$450 or less (<code>project.yaml</code> budget, kept 2026-09-25). The budget excludes the optional assist kit,	Priced BOM	Met: \$426

ID	Requirement	Target	Verification (TRL 3 or later)	Status at TRL 3
		which is a later second prototype, and the SwapCell pack, which is priced once in the SwapCell BOM (redefined 2026-09-25, WWK-DDR-001)		
R12	Repairable in a rural market	All wear parts (tires, tubes, spokes, bearings, cables, brake shoes) are standard 26 in bicycle parts; mild steel frame repairable by a local welder; only common hand and bicycle tools needed	Design review of the BOM; later review with a local mechanic	At risk: 100 mm drum hubs are less common than rim-brake hubs
R13	Assist-ready (new 2026-09-25)	The first prototype carries mounting points for a later assist kit built to SwapCell interface v0.3: a plate for a latch class V1 vehicle receiver above the tires, with the pack's back and lid faces open to air; rear dropouts that accept a 100 mm hub motor with a torque-arm tab; a boss for a push sensor at the hip bar. The receiver fits a 10 k Ω INTERLOCK coding resistor (item W), and the assist draws no more than the 15 A legacy-mode limit	Parametric model; later latch class V1 test	Not verifiable at TRL 3: geometry present, 7.3 A peak

■ Assumptions

- A 20 L jerrycan weighs about 1.1 kg empty and measures about 360 x 175 x 430 mm. A 20 L clay pot is assumed to be about 380 mm in diameter and 5 to 8 kg empty.
- Sustained push forces are set with reference to published manual-handling guidance, which suggests roughly 100 to 150 N for sustained pushing by women over long distances and more for short efforts. The limits must be confirmed with the users, including girls and older women.
- A household of five uses about 100 L per day (about 20 L per person).
- The first prototype has no assist (WWK-DDR-001), so R3 cannot be met by it; R3 stays as the target for the later assist prototype, which needs about 230 N of thrust (two hub motors) to meet it on the loosest sand (WWK-CAL-001).
- R5 allows a larger circle than a compact rollator because the concept needs a long wheelbase to keep the swivelling front wheels clear of the cradle (WWK-PRC-001). A three-point turn is expected on paths narrower than 4 m.